

August 2026

Dear Americo,

I've worked in Lamorinda long enough to know that a two-home compound on a hillside acre in Lafayette doesn't come along often, and 1603 Reliez Valley Road caught my attention the moment it listed. The combination of a refreshed main home with four balconies and valley views alongside what sounds like a genuinely architectural ADU believed to be designed by Leon Meyer is the kind of offering that serious buyers remember. When the listing came off the market after 105 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out because I don't think the property was the problem.

What the listing history suggests to me is a strategy gap, not a value gap. At \$545 per square foot, the home was priced meaningfully below the Lafayette range for a renovated property with this footprint and setting, which should have been an advantage. Instead, the pricing story was never told in a way that gave buyers the context to understand what they were getting. The ADU alone, with its redwood walls, walls of windows, and independent address, is a lifestyle asset that most buyers have never encountered. That story deserved its own spotlight, not a footnote.

I've put together a short packet that walks through the three friction points I believe kept qualified buyers from connecting with this property, along with a positioning analysis and a framework for how I'd approach a relaunch differently. It's meant to give you something concrete to look at, not a sales pitch.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside. If you're not, I'd enjoy a conversation at whatever pace makes sense for you.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Ben Olsen", with a long horizontal line extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

1603 Reliez Valley Road

Lafayette, CA 94549

7.0 Beds · 0 Baths · 4,314 Sq Ft · Lafayette

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 1603 Reliez Valley Road

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Rare Lafayette Hillside Compound with Architectural Character - and a Listing That Didn't Show It

1603 Reliez Valley Road is genuinely uncommon inventory for Lafayette. A 4,314 square foot two-home compound on a full acre of hillside, with a refreshed 2,654 square foot main residence featuring vaulted ceilings, hardwood floors, four balconies, and expansive views, paired with a 1,660 square foot ADU believed to have been designed by architect Leon Meyer. The ADU isn't a converted garage. It's a three-bedroom, two-bath retreat with walls of windows, oiled redwood, a remodeled primary suite, and its own address and parking. Buyers who are looking for multigenerational living, rental income potential, or a private creative or work space don't find something like this often in Lafayette. The Sport Court, EV charger, outdoor BBQ and entertaining area, and the hillside privacy round out a property with real lifestyle depth.

The listing spent 105 days on the market and came off without a sale. That outcome doesn't reflect the fundamentals of the property. At \$545 per square foot, the compound was priced well below the Lafayette renovated benchmark of \$780 to \$840 per square foot, which should have generated strong buyer interest. The gap between value and outcome points to a strategy problem: the marketing never built the case for what this property actually is. A two-home compound requires a different narrative and a different buyer than a single-family listing, and a standard approach to distribution leaves that buyer pool largely untouched.

\$2,350,000

List Price

\$545/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch needs to lead with the compound story, not bury it. The right buyers for this property are actively looking for something they can't find in conventional inventory, and they need to be found where they're actually searching, not waited for in a standard MLS queue.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: 105 Days Without a Pivot

After 105 days on the market, buyer psychology had long since shifted. Past the 45-day mark, buyers stop asking whether a home is worth looking at and start asking what's wrong with it. That doubt wasn't earned by the property. A two-home compound on a hillside acre with architectural ADU and valley views is exactly what a subset of Lafayette buyers has been waiting to find. The listing ran its course without a visible change in strategy, which meant it never had a fresh start with a new audience. The clock ran out before the right buyer was ever genuinely reached.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's off-market private buyer list at offmarket.brightworkrealty.com gives a relaunched property a clean reset with buyers who are actively opted in to receive property alerts before anything reappears on Zillow, bypassing the stale-listing stigma entirely.

Friction #2: The ADU Story Was Never the Headline

The Leon Meyer-attributed ADU is the property's most distinctive asset, and it needed its own marketing moment. A 1,660 square foot retreat with oiled redwood, walls of windows, a remodeled primary suite with an impressive closet, a built-in office, and a private patio is not a footnote. It's a lifestyle category of its own, whether a buyer is thinking about multigenerational living, rental income, a guest house, or a private studio. When that story lives in the middle of a long listing description without visual depth to back it up, buyers who would have made the drive to see it never got the prompt to do so. The compound format has a specific buyer, and that buyer needed to be shown the ADU, not told about it.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

A 3D Matterport tour of both structures, navigable independently, gives buyers the spatial experience of the ADU before they ever set foot on the property, which is exactly the kind of visual proof that turns a browser into a scheduled showing.

Friction #3: The Buyer Who Needed This Was Never Actively Found

At \$2,350,000, this property sits in a price band where the buyer pool is selective and well-informed. Lafayette buyers at this level are comparing carefully and often shopping across multiple cities before committing to a showing. In that environment, passive MLS distribution is not enough. The buyers most likely to value a two-home compound with architectural character and hillside privacy, whether they are coming from San Francisco, Oakland, or the broader East Bay, were not being actively reached. They were waiting to be found, and the listing wasn't built to find them.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns reach SF and East Bay buyers who are actively researching Lamorinda before they've identified a specific property, putting this compound in front of the right audience at the moment they're forming their search.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	1603 Reliez Valley Rd	Lafayette Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$545/sqft	Renovated: \$780–\$840/sqft Premium: \$850–\$920/sqft
Lot / Setting	1.03 acres, hillside with valley views	Typical lots 0.25–0.50 acres, mostly flat to gently sloped
Architectural Character	Main home with vaulted ceilings + Leon Meyer-attributed ADU with oiled redwood and walls of windows	Standard single-family construction, minimal architectural distinction
Premium Features	Four balconies, Sport Court, independent ADU with separate address and parking, EV charger, outdoor entertaining area	Single-structure home, standard yard
HOA	None	Varies; \$0–\$300/mo depending on community

The verdict: At \$545/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$780-\$840/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$545 per square foot, this compound was listed at the low end of the Lafayette fixer range, well below what even a standard renovated home in this city commands, despite offering a refreshed main residence, an architecturally distinctive ADU, hillside acreage, and no HOA. The numbers made the case for value. The strategy never made the case for what that value actually looked like. A relaunch with the right narrative and distribution has meaningful room to work with.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Tell the Compound Story First

1603 Reliez Valley Road is not a single-family home with a bonus unit. It's a two-home compound on a hillside acre, and that's the story that leads every piece of marketing. The main home's four balconies and valley views, the ADU's architectural character and fully independent layout, and the Sport Court and outdoor living infrastructure add up to something specific and rare. Buyers looking for this kind of flexibility are a distinct audience, and they need to see it framed that way from the first image they encounter.

Pillar II - Give the ADU Its Own Visual Identity

An ADU attributed to Leon Meyer, with oiled redwood, walls of windows, and a remodeled primary suite, earns its own photography, its own virtual tour, and its own narrative section. Buyers can't feel the architectural character of that space from a standard listing photo. A Zillow Showcase presentation with a dedicated section for each structure, supported by immersive media, gives serious buyers the visual depth they need to understand what they're considering before they schedule a showing.

Pillar III - Reach the Buyer Who Is Still Looking

The buyer for this property exists. They may be in San Francisco weighing a move to the East Bay. They may be in Oakland looking for more space and privacy without leaving the region they know. They are informed, deliberate, and shopping at a price point where they can wait for the right thing. BrightWork's geo-targeted campaigns and private buyer network are built specifically to reach that buyer before they've found what they're looking for, and to put this compound in front of them at the right moment.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

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The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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